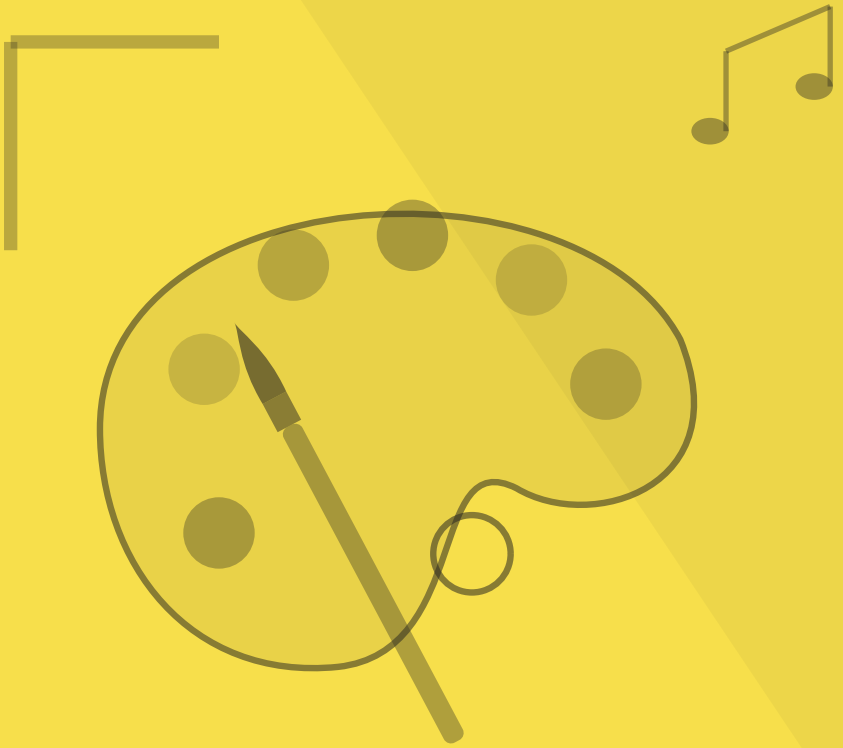
VENVLEARNING

STUDENT TEXTBOOK



Art

GRADE 7

Lessons, examples, and practice for the whole year

2 units

VENVLEARNING

Grade 7
Art

STUDENT TEXTBOOK

Unit 1 The Elements of Art
Unit 2 Modern Art and Architecture

A VenvLearning family homeschool curriculum

How to use this book

Every lesson starts on a new page with the same parts, so you always know where to look. Read about the idea, study the Step by Step demonstrations, then make art in the Create studio activity. Your practice pages are in your Student Workbook, labeled with the same lesson number.

- Today's Goal (the box with the target) says what you will be able to do by the end of the lesson.
- Today's Assignment is your checklist for the day. Tick each box as you finish it.
- Each lesson page has three panels. The wide center panel is the lesson, in numbered steps: 1 Get Ready, 2 Learn, and 3 Check Your Understanding.
- The left panel holds things to remember: Key Ideas (the most important rule or fact; learn these), Watch Out warnings about common mistakes, tips, and a Remember note that sums up the lesson. Each one sits beside the part of the lesson it goes with.
- The right panel holds Words to Know (definitions), what to read in your Reader, and other extras.
- Pages that look like a page from a book, on cream paper with a brown READING tab, are things to read: stories, excerpts, and articles.
- Create boxes tell you about each studio project and what to gather. Do it on the Studio Sheet in your workbook, where the steps and your sketching space are. Keep everything you make in your portfolio folder.
- At the end of each week of lessons there is a short Sketchbook Check in your workbook. Each unit ends with the Portfolio Review.

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UNIT 1

The Elements of Art

Critique, line and mark-making, form and light, proportion, color schemes, chiaroscuro, composition, and the artist statement.

Skilled artists combine sharp eyes with deliberate choices. In this unit you'll learn a professional critique method, build drawing skills (mark-making, light logic, proportion), use color theory and dramatic value, plan strong compositions, and finish a revised work with an artist statement.

In this unit you will...

- Critique art using describe, analyze, interpret, judge.
- Use contour, gesture, and value techniques; render light on forms.
- Apply proportion, color schemes, and chiaroscuro.
- Plan compositions, revise with critique, and write an artist statement.

ART IN YOUR WORLD

Illustrators, game artists, photographers, and filmmakers use light, color, and composition to steer attention and emotion.

UNIT VOCABULARY

critique	Structured discussion of art.
hatching	Parallel lines for value.
chiaroscuro	Strong light-dark contrast.
analogous	Neighboring colors.
rule of thirds	Placing key elements on thirds.
artist statement	Explanation of an artwork.

Lessons in this unit

Lesson	Title
1.1	Looking Closely: The Four-Step Critique
1.2	Line and Mark-Making
1.3	Form and Light
1.4	Proportion and the Human Figure
1.5	Color Theory and Color Schemes
1.6	Value, Contrast, and Chiaroscuro
1.7	Composition: Thirds, Leading Lines, and Balance
1.8	Revision, Critique, and the Artist Statement

REMEMBER

LESSON 1.1
Week 1 · Lesson 1 of 2
Unit 1: The Elements of Art

Lesson 1.1: Looking Closely: The Four-Step Critique

TODAY'S GOAL

I can analyze an artwork using describe, analyze, interpret, and judge.

Standards: NCAS VA:Re7, VA:Re8, VA:Re9

TODAY'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Do the Warm-Up in Workbook Lesson 1.1, Part A.
- [ ] Read Lesson 1.1 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Create activity, Critique Practice, on your Studio Sheet (Workbook Lesson 1.1, Part B).
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.1, Part C.
- [ ] Finish Workbook Lesson 1.1: Part D.

1 Get Ready

LOOK AND WONDER

Why do people disagree about whether an artwork is "good"? Can an opinion about art be supported with evidence?

2 Learn

Art critic Edmund Feldman described a four-step method that moves from facts to opinions, so judgments rest on

WORDS & MORE

WORDS TO KNOW

elements of art
Line, shape, form, color, value, texture, and space.

principles of design
How artists arrange the elements: balance, contrast, emphasis, movement, pattern, rhythm, unity, and proportion.

critique
A structured, thoughtful discussion of an artwork.

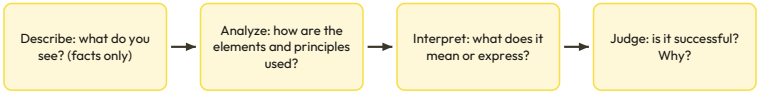
interpret
To explain what an artwork means or expresses.

LOOK AT

The Migration Series
Jacob Lawrence, 1940–41
The Phillips Collection and MoMA · lawrence migration.phillipscollection.org

REMEMBER

evidence:



Practice on The Migration Series (1940–41) by Jacob Lawrence, a set of 60 small paintings about the Great Migration of African Americans from the rural South to Northern cities, the same history you read about in ELA. Lawrence used a limited palette of bold, flat colors and repeated shapes, so the whole series reads like one story. Many panels can be viewed online through the Phillips Collection and the Museum of Modern Art, which each own half of the series.

STEP BY STEP · CRITIQUE ONE PANEL

Choose any panel from The Migration Series.

1. Describe: list figures, objects, colors, and words in the caption.
2. Analyze: find repeated shapes, strong diagonals, or the limited color palette.
3. Interpret: what feeling or message does the panel express about the migration?
4. Judge: does it communicate that message well? Give evidence from steps 1–3.

Look for: A judgment that grows from description and analysis is persuasive, even if others disagree.

CREATE · CRITIQUE PRACTICE

Can you support an opinion about art with evidence?

You need: internet access or an art book; drawing paper.

Do it on your Studio Sheet: Workbook Lesson 1.1, Part B. The steps and a place to record your results are all there.

KEY IDEA

Describe, analyze, interpret, judge: build opinions about art on evidence.

✓ REMEMBER

Describe, analyze, interpret, judge.

WORDS & MORE

REMEMBER

WORDS & MORE

3 Check Your Understanding

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Directions: Answer each question. Write your answers in Workbook Lesson 1.1, Part C. Then check with your teacher.

1. Which critique step lists facts only?
2. Which step explains meaning?
3. What did The Migration Series depict?

REMEMBER

LESSON 1.2
Week 1 · Lesson 2 of 2

Unit 1: The Elements of Art

Lesson 1.2: Line and Mark-Making

TODAY'S GOAL

I can use contour, gesture, hatching, cross-hatching, and stippling to describe form and value.

Standards: NCAS VA:Cr2

TODAY'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Do the Warm-Up in Workbook Lesson 1.2, Part A.
- [ ] Read Lesson 1.2 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Create activity, Mark-Making Value Studies, on your Studio Sheet (Workbook Lesson 1.2, Part B).
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.2, Part C.
- [ ] Finish Workbook Lesson 1.2: Part D.

1 Get Ready

LOOK AND WONDER

How can a drawing made only of black lines show light and shadow?

2 Learn

Line can describe edges, movement, and even value. A contour line traces edges slowly. A blind contour, drawn without looking at the paper, trains your eye to see. A gesture drawing captures movement in seconds. To build

WORDS & MORE

WORDS TO KNOW

contour drawing
A drawing of an object's edges, made with careful, continuous line.

gesture drawing
A quick drawing that captures movement and pose.

hatching
Parallel lines that create value; cross-hatching layers them in different directions.

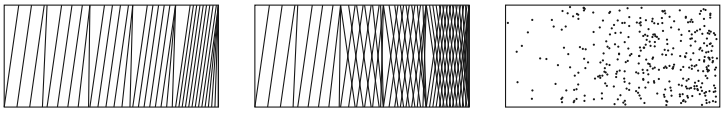
stippling
Dots that create value; closer dots look darker.

LOOK AT

Rhinoceros (woodcut)
Albrecht Dürer, 1515
National Gallery of Art · nga.gov

REMEMBER

value with line, artists use hatching, cross-hatching, and stippling.



hatching cross-hatching stippling

The German artist Albrecht Dürer (1471–1528) was a master of hatching in engravings and woodcuts. In his woodcut Rhinoceros (1515), patterns of lines create both texture and value, even though Dürer never saw the animal; he worked from a written description and a sketch by someone else.

KEY IDEA

Line can describe edges (contour), movement (gesture), and value (hatching, cross-hatching, stippling).

✓ REMEMBER

Contour, gesture, hatching, cross-hatching, stippling.

WORDS & MORE

CREATE · MARK-MAKING VALUE STUDIES

Which technique makes the smoothest value change?

You need: fine black pen or sharp pencil; drawing paper.

Do it on your Studio Sheet: Workbook Lesson 1.2, Part B. The steps and a place to record your results are all there.

3 Check Your Understanding

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Directions: Answer each question. Write your answers in Workbook Lesson 1.2, Part C. Then check with your teacher.

1. What is hatching?
2. Which technique uses dots?
3. Why do blind contours?

REMEMBER

LESSON 1.3
Week 2 · Lesson 1 of 2

Unit 1: The Elements of Art

Lesson 1.3: Form and Light

TODAY'S GOAL

I can render a form using a consistent light source with highlight, midtone, core shadow, reflected light, and cast shadow.

Standards: NCAS VA:Cr2, VA:Cr3

TODAY'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Do the Warm-Up in Workbook Lesson 1.3, Part A.
- [ ] Read Lesson 1.3 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Create activity, Still Life with One Light, on your Studio Sheet (Workbook Lesson 1.3, Part B).
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.3, Part C.
- [ ] Finish Workbook Lesson 1.3: Part D.

1 Get Ready

LOOK AND WONDER

Shine a flashlight on a ball in a dark room. Where is it brightest? Where is it darkest? Is the edge of the shadow side completely black?

2 Learn

Realistic drawing depends on light logic: every form in a picture is lit from the same direction. On a sphere, value changes gradually from the highlight through the midtones

WORDS & MORE

WORDS TO KNOW

light source
The direction light comes from.

highlight
The brightest spot, where light hits most directly.

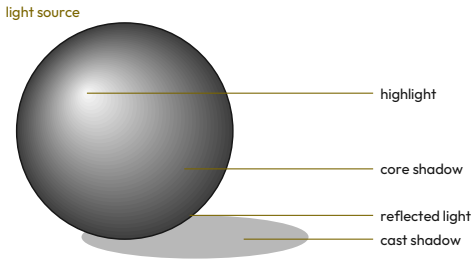
core shadow
The darkest part on the form, turned away from the light.

reflected light
Dim light bounced back onto the shadow side from nearby surfaces.

cast shadow
The shadow an object throws onto another surface.

REMEMBER

to the core shadow. Near the edge of the shadow side, light bounces back from the table as reflected light. The darkest dark is usually the cast shadow right where the object touches the surface.



WORDS & MORE

KEY IDEA

Keep one light source. Render highlight, midtone, core shadow, reflected light, and cast shadow.

CREATE · STILL LIFE WITH ONE LIGHT

Can you render three forms lit the same way?

You need: a ball, a box, and a can or cup; flashlight or desk lamp; pencils (2H, HB, 4B if you have them); blending stump or tissue.

Do it on your Studio Sheet: Workbook Lesson 1.3, Part B. The steps and a place to record your results are all there.

✓ REMEMBER

One light source; five parts of light on every form.

3 Check Your Understanding

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Directions: Answer each question. Write your answers in Workbook Lesson 1.3, Part C. Then check with your teacher.

1. Where is the darkest part of a cast shadow?
2. Why is reflected light dimmer than the lit side?
3. What goes wrong with two light directions?

REMEMBER

LESSON 1.4
Week 2 · Lesson 2 of 2

Unit 1: The Elements of Art

Lesson 1.4: Proportion and the Human Figure

TODAY'S GOAL

I can use proportion guidelines to draw a face and a standing figure.

Standards: NCAS VA:Cr2, VA:Cn11

TODAY'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Do the Warm-Up in Workbook Lesson 1.4, Part A.
- [ ] Read Lesson 1.4 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Create activity, Measured Portrait and Figure, on your Studio Sheet (Workbook Lesson 1.4, Part B).
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.4, Part C.
- [ ] Finish Workbook Lesson 1.4: Part D.

1 Get Ready

LOOK AND WONDER

How many of your head-heights tall do you think you are? Guess, then measure with a partner.

2 Learn

Artists have measured the body for thousands of years. Around 1490, Leonardo da Vinci drew the Vitruvian Man, a figure inside a circle and a square, based on the Roman architect Vitruvius's ideas about ideal proportions. Today artists often use the head as a unit: an adult is roughly 7½ heads tall (fashion and comic illustrators often stretch it to 8

WORDS & MORE

WORDS TO KNOW

proportion
Size relationships between parts and the whole.

canon of proportion
A set of rules for ideal body proportions.

foreshortening
Drawing an object that points toward the viewer so it looks shorter.

LOOK AT

Vitruvian Man
Leonardo da Vinci, about 1490
Gallerie dell'Accademia, Venice (search the title for a photo)

REMEMBER

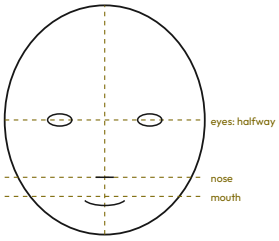
or more).

On the face, the eyes sit about halfway down the head.

The bottom of the nose is about halfway between the eyes and the chin; the mouth is about a third of the way from nose to chin.

The tops of the ears line up with the brow; the bottoms with the nose.

On the body, the hips are near the halfway point, and the fingertips reach mid-thigh.



WORDS & MORE

KEY IDEA

Use the head as a unit: eyes halfway down the head, an adult about 7½ heads tall. Measure real people to test the rules.

✓ REMEMBER

The head is the unit: eyes halfway, adult about 7½ heads.

CREATE · MEASURED PORTRAIT AND FIGURE

Do proportion rules match real people?

You need: pencil; measuring tape; mirror; a partner or a photo.

Do it on your Studio Sheet: Workbook Lesson 1.4, Part B. The steps and a place to record your results are all there.

3 Check Your Understanding

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Directions: Answer each question. Write your answers in Workbook Lesson 1.4, Part C. Then check with your teacher.

1. About how many heads tall is an adult?
2. Who drew the Vitruvian Man?
3. Where do the ears line up?

REMEMBER

LESSON 1.5
Week 3 · Lesson 1 of 2

Unit 1: The Elements of Art

Lesson 1.5: Color Theory and Color Schemes

TODAY'S GOAL

I can describe hue, saturation, and value, and use color schemes to create mood.

Standards: NCAS VA:Cr2, VA:Re8

TODAY'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Do the Warm-Up in Workbook Lesson 1.5, Part A.
- [ ] Read Lesson 1.5 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Create activity, One Image, Two Moods, on your Studio Sheet (Workbook Lesson 1.5, Part B).
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.5, Part C.
- [ ] Finish Workbook Lesson 1.5: Parts D–E.

1 Get Ready

LOOK AND WONDER

Why do sunsets feel warm and oceans feel calm? Is it the color, or what we associate with it?

2 Learn

Every color has three properties: hue (its name), value (light or dark), and saturation (bright or dull). Mixing a color with

WORDS & MORE

WORDS TO KNOW

hue
The name of a color on the wheel (red, blue-green).

saturation
How intense or dull a color is (also called intensity).

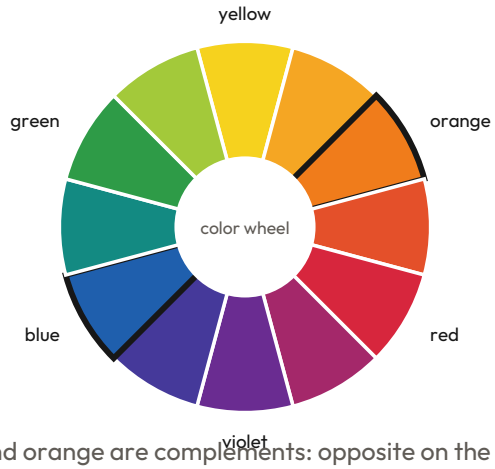
complementary
Colors opposite on the wheel.

analogous
Colors next to each other on the wheel.

triadic
Three colors evenly spaced around the wheel.

REMEMBER

its complement lowers saturation, making it duller or grayer. Artists choose color schemes to set a mood.



Blue and orange are complements: opposite on the wheel.

Scheme	Colors	Effect
monochromatic	tints and shades of one hue	unified, calm
analogous	3–4 neighbors (yellow, yellow-green, green)	harmonious, natural
complementary	opposites (blue and orange)	high contrast, energetic
split-complementary	one hue + the two neighbors of its complement	contrast with less tension
triadic	three evenly spaced hues (red, yellow, blue)	lively, balanced
warm / cool	reds, oranges, yellows / blues, greens, violets	warm advances; cool recedes

KEY IDEA

Hue, value, and saturation describe any color. Color schemes control harmony, contrast, and mood.

✓ REMEMBER

Hue, value, saturation; schemes create mood.

CREATE · ONE IMAGE, TWO MOODS

How does a color scheme change meaning?

You need: colored pencils, markers, or paint; two copies of a simple line drawing.

Do it on your Studio Sheet: Workbook Lesson 1.5, Part B. The steps and a place to record your results are all there.

WORDS & MORE

REMEMBER

3 Check Your Understanding

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Directions: Write the color or term for each item, or answer the question. Write your answers in Workbook Lesson 1.5, Part C. Then check with your teacher.

1. Complement of red
2. Analogous colors are...
3. How do you lower a color's saturation?

WORDS & MORE

REMEMBER

LESSON 1.6
Week 3 · Lesson 2 of 2
Unit 1: The Elements of Art

Lesson 1.6: Value, Contrast, and Chiaroscuro

TODAY'S GOAL

I can make a nine-step value scale and use strong contrast (chiaroscuro) for drama.

Standards: NCAS VA:Cr2, VA:Re7

TODAY'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Do the Warm-Up in Workbook Lesson 1.6, Part A.
- [ ] Read Lesson 1.6 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Create activity, Dramatic Light Study, on your Studio Sheet (Workbook Lesson 1.6, Part B).
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.6, Part C.
- [ ] Finish Workbook Lesson 1.6: Part D.

1 Get Ready

LOOK AND WONDER

Watch a scary movie scene with the sound off. How does lighting create the mood?

2 Learn

A value scale is a ruler for darkness. Artists train by making even steps from white to black, then use that control to model forms.

WORDS & MORE

WORDS TO KNOW

value scale
A sequence of even steps from white to black.

chiaroscuro
Italian for "light-dark": strong contrast between light and shadow.

tenebrism
Extreme chiaroscuro, with figures emerging from deep darkness.

LOOK AT

The Calling of Saint Matthew
Caravaggio, about 1600
San Luigi dei Francesi, Rome (search the title for a photo)

REMEMBER



Italian painters of the Renaissance and Baroque periods used chiaroscuro to make figures look solid and dramatic. Caravaggio (1571–1610) pushed it to extremes, called tenebrism: in The Calling of Saint Matthew (about 1600), a beam of light cuts across a dark room and lands on the faces of the men at the table. Rembrandt later used warm, glowing light against deep shadow in his portraits.

WORDS & MORE

KEY IDEA

Control value with even steps; strong light-dark contrast (chiaroscuro) creates drama and solidity.

CREATE · DRAMATIC LIGHT STUDY

How does strong side lighting change an object?

You need: one object (a mug, an apple, a toy); flashlight; dark paper and white charcoal or chalk, or pencil on white paper.

Do it on your Studio Sheet: Workbook Lesson 1.6, Part B. The steps and a place to record your results are all there.

✓ REMEMBER

Even value steps; chiaroscuro for drama.

3 Check Your Understanding

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Directions: Answer each question. Write your answers in Workbook Lesson 1.6, Part C. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does chiaroscuro mean?
2. Which artist is known for tenebrism?
3. How many steps in the class value scale?

REMEMBER

LESSON 1.7
Week 4 · Lesson 1 of 2

Unit 1: The Elements of Art

Lesson 1.7: Composition: Thirds, Leading Lines, and Balance

TODAY'S GOAL

I can plan a composition using the rule of thirds, leading lines, emphasis, and asymmetrical balance.

Standards: NCAS VA:Cr1, VA:Cr2

TODAY'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Do the Warm-Up in Workbook Lesson 1.7, Part A.
- [ ] Read Lesson 1.7 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Create activity, Four Thumbnails, on your Studio Sheet (Workbook Lesson 1.7, Part B).
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.7, Part C.
- [ ] Finish Workbook Lesson 1.7: Part D.

1 Get Ready

LOOK AND WONDER

Where does your eye go first in a movie poster? What tricks get it there?

2 Learn

WORDS & MORE

WORDS TO KNOW

rule of thirds
Dividing an image into thirds and placing key elements on the lines or crossings.

leading lines
Lines that guide the eye toward the focal point.

negative space
The empty space around and between objects.

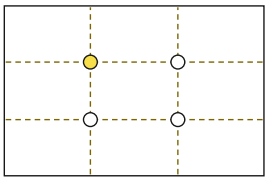
asymmetrical balance
Different elements arranged so visual weight feels even.

LOOK AT

The Great Wave off Kanagawa
Katsushika Hokusai, about 1831
The Metropolitan Museum of Art · metmuseum.org

REMEMBER

Strong compositions guide the viewer. The rule of thirds places the focal point near one of four crossing points instead of dead center.



Leading lines (roads, rivers, arms, edges) point the eye to it. Asymmetrical balance keeps the picture interesting, and negative space gives the subject room to breathe.

WORDS & MORE

In The Great Wave off Kanagawa (about 1831), Katsushika Hokusai builds a powerful asymmetrical composition: the giant wave fills the left and top, its claw-like crest leads the eye across to tiny Mount Fuji, and the boats curve along the wave's path. The small mountain balances the huge wave.

KEY IDEA

Place the focal point thoughtfully, lead the eye to it, balance asymmetrically, and use negative space.

✓ REMEMBER

Thirds, leading lines, balance, negative space.

CREATE · FOUR THUMBNAILS

Which composition tells your idea best?

You need: pencil; drawing paper.

Do it on your Studio Sheet: Workbook Lesson 1.7, Part B. The steps and a place to record your results are all there.

3 Check Your Understanding

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Directions: Answer each question. Write your answers in Workbook Lesson 1.7, Part C. Then check with your teacher.

1. What are leading lines?
2. What balances the great wave in Hokusai's print?
3. Why value-only thumbnails?

REMEMBER

LESSON 1.8
Week 4 · Lesson 2 of 2
Unit 1: The Elements of Art

Lesson 1.8: Revision, Critique, and the Artist Statement

TODAY'S GOAL

I can revise a work using peer critique and write an artist statement explaining my choices.

Standards: NCAS VA:Cr3, VA:Pr5, VA:Re9

TODAY'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Do the Warm-Up in Workbook Lesson 1.8, Part A.
- [ ] Read Lesson 1.8 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Create activity, Final Piece and Statement, on your Studio Sheet (Workbook Lesson 1.8, Part B).
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.8, Part C.

1 Get Ready

LOOK AND WONDER

Have you ever read the small card next to a painting in a museum? What makes one interesting to read?

2 Learn

Develop your best thumbnail into a finished piece. Midway, hold a short critique using three prompts: I notice... (description), I wonder... (a question), What if... (a suggestion). Then revise.

WORDS & MORE

WORDS TO KNOW

artist statement
A short text in which an artist explains their work, process, and choices.

peer critique
Structured feedback from classmates or family.

REMEMBER

Finish with an artist statement of 75–150 words: what you made, the elements and principles you used and why, what you changed after feedback, and what you want viewers to feel or think.

WORDS & MORE

STEP BY STEP · ARTIST STATEMENT STARTER

A charcoal drawing of a grandmother's hands

1 What: “This charcoal drawing shows my grandmother's hands holding a quilt square.”

2 How: “I used chiaroscuro and a rule-of-thirds composition, with the quilt's lines leading to her hands.”

3 Revision: “After feedback, I darkened the background so the hands stand out.”

4 Meaning: “I want viewers to see how hands carry family stories.”

Look for: Clear, specific, and personal.

KEY IDEA

Critique with I notice / I wonder / What if; revise; explain your choices in an artist statement.

CREATE · FINAL PIECE AND STATEMENT

Can you finish, critique, revise, and explain a work?

You need: your chosen thumbnail; drawing paper; your choice of media.

Do it on your Studio Sheet: Workbook Lesson 1.8, Part B. The steps and a place to record your results are all there.

✓ REMEMBER

Critique, revise, and explain your choices.

3 Check Your Understanding

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Directions: Answer each question. Write your answers in Workbook Lesson 1.8, Part C. Then check with your teacher.

1. Name the three critique prompts.
2. How long is the artist statement?
3. Name two things an artist statement includes.

UNIT 1 REVIEW

Unit 1 Study Guide

Use this page to get ready for the unit test. Read each big idea, then try the review pages in your workbook.

Lesson	Remember…
1.1	Describe, analyze, interpret, judge.
1.2	Contour, gesture, hatching, cross-hatching, stippling.
1.3	One light source; five parts of light on every form.
1.4	The head is the unit: eyes halfway, adult about 7½ heads.
1.5	Hue, value, saturation; schemes create mood.
1.6	Even value steps; chiaroscuro for drama.
1.7	Thirds, leading lines, balance, negative space.
1.8	Critique, revise, and explain your choices.

UNIT 2

Modern Art and Architecture

Surrealism, Abstract Expressionism and Color Field painting, geometric abstraction, abstraction from nature, modern architecture, and a portfolio show.

In the 1900s, artists broke every rule. They painted dreams, dripped paint across the floor, built pictures from pure color and geometry, and designed buildings that cantilever over waterfalls. In this unit you'll study Surrealism, Abstract Expressionism, abstraction, and modern architecture, try each artist's techniques yourself, and finish by curating a portfolio show with your own artist statement.

In this unit you will...

- Explain the goals and techniques of Surrealism.
- Analyze and practice action painting and Color Field painting.
- Use rhythm, balance, and simplification to make abstract art.
- Explain modern architecture and design for a site and purpose.
- Curate a portfolio and write an artist statement.

ART IN YOUR WORLD

Graphic designers, architects, filmmakers, and interior designers still use Surrealist surprise, Mondrian's grids, Color Field mood, and modern ideas of form and function.

UNIT VOCABULARY

Surrealism	Art of dreams and the unconscious.
abstract	Art without recognizable objects.
gesture	A mark that records movement.
Color Field	Large areas of color creating mood.
asymmetrical balance	Different sides with equal visual weight.
form follows function	A building's shape comes from its purpose.

Lessons in this unit

Lesson	Title
2.1	Surrealism: Dreams and the Impossible
2.2	Surrealist Techniques: Collage and Chance
2.3	Abstract Expressionism: Action Painting
2.4	Color Field Painting
2.5	Rhythm and Geometry: Kandinsky and Mondrian
2.6	Abstraction from Nature: O'Keeffe and Alma Thomas
2.7	Twentieth-Century Architecture: Form Follows Function
2.8	Modern Art Portfolio and Artist Statement

REMEMBER

LESSON 2.1
Week 1 · Lesson 1 of 2

Unit 2: Modern Art and Architecture

Lesson 2.1: Surrealism: Dreams and the Impossible

TODAY'S GOAL

I can explain the goals of Surrealism and analyze how artists made realistic-looking images of impossible things.

Standards: NCAS VA:Re7.2, VA:Re8

TODAY'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Do the Warm-Up in Workbook Lesson 2.1, Part A.
- [ ] Read Lesson 2.1 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Create activity, Dream Journal Sketch, on your Studio Sheet (Workbook Lesson 2.1, Part B).
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 2.1, Part C.
- [ ] Finish Workbook Lesson 2.1: Parts D–E.

1 Get Ready

LOOK AND WONDER

Think of the strangest dream you remember. What made it feel strange even though it seemed real at the time?

2 Learn

WORDS & MORE

WORDS TO KNOW

Surrealism
An art movement of the 1920s–1940s that explored dreams, the unconscious mind, and impossible scenes.

unconscious
The part of the mind that holds thoughts and feelings we aren't aware of.

juxtaposition
Placing very different things side by side to surprise the viewer.

illusionism
Painting so realistically that something seems real.

REMEMBER

In 1924, the French writer André Breton published the Surrealist Manifesto. He and his friends believed that dreams and the unconscious mind held a deeper truth than everyday logic. Surrealist artists painted dreamlike scenes, often with careful, realistic technique, so impossible things looked believable.

Salvador Dalí's The Persistence of Memory (1931) is one of the most famous Surrealist paintings. Soft pocket watches droop over a branch, a ledge, and a strange sleeping creature, in a quiet landscape of cliffs and sea. Dalí painted the watches with tiny brushes and smooth illusionism, making melting time seem real.

The Belgian painter René Magritte used juxtaposition and words to make viewers question what they see. In The Treachery of Images (1929), he painted a pipe and wrote underneath, in French, “This is not a pipe.” He was right: it's a picture of a pipe. In The Son of Man (1964), a floating green apple hides a man's face.

Surrealist strategy	Example
a soft object that should be hard	melting watches (Dalí)
juxtaposition of unrelated things	an apple in front of a face (Magritte)
words that contradict the image	“This is not a pipe” (Magritte)
a dream landscape	endless empty plains and long shadows

STEP BY STEP · ANALYZE A SURREALIST IMAGE

Use the four-step critique from Unit 1 on The Persistence of Memory.

1 Describe: soft watches, a bare branch, cliffs, calm water, an orange watch covered in ants.

2 Analyze: smooth realistic shading and deep space make the scene look real.

3 Interpret: time might feel soft or strange in dreams or memory.

4 Judge: it succeeds because the realistic style makes the impossible feel true.

Look for: Realistic technique plus impossible content is the heart of Surrealism.

WORDS & MORE

LOOK AT

The Persistence of Memory
Salvador Dalí, 1931
Museum of Modern Art, New York · moma.org

The Treachery of Images
René Magritte, 1929
Los Angeles County Museum of Art · lacma.org

The Son of Man
René Magritte, 1964
Private collection (search the title for a photo)

REMEMBER

KEY IDEA

Surrealists explored dreams and the unconscious, often using realistic technique for impossible scenes. Juxtaposition and contradiction make viewers question what they see.

✓ REMEMBER

Surrealists painted dreamlike, impossible scenes with realistic technique.

CREATE · DREAM JOURNAL SKETCH

Can you draw an impossible scene so it looks real?

You need: a sketchbook; pencils (2H, HB, 4B); an eraser.

Do it on your Studio Sheet: Workbook Lesson 2.1, Part B. The steps and a place to record your results are all there.

3 Check Your Understanding

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Directions: Answer each question. Write your answers in Workbook Lesson 2.1, Part C. Then check with your teacher.

1. When did the Surrealist movement begin?
2. What is strange about the watches in The Persistence of Memory?
3. What is juxtaposition?

WORDS & MORE

REMEMBER

LESSON 2.2
Week 1 · Lesson 2 of 2

Unit 2: Modern Art and Architecture

Lesson 2.2: Surrealist Techniques: Collage and Chance

TODAY'S GOAL

I can use collage, scale change, and chance-based games to create a Surrealist artwork.

Standards: NCAS VA:Cr1.1, VA:Cr2.1

TODAY'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Do the Warm-Up in Workbook Lesson 2.2, Part A.
- [ ] Read Lesson 2.2 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Create activity, Surreal Collage, on your Studio Sheet (Workbook Lesson 2.2, Part B).
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 2.2, Part C.
- [ ] Finish Workbook Lesson 2.2: Part D.

1 Get Ready

LOOK AND WONDER

What would happen if you drew the head of a creature, folded the paper, and someone else drew the body without looking?

2 Learn

Surrealists invented techniques that let chance and surprise take over. In automatism, an artist draws quickly without

WORDS & MORE

WORDS TO KNOW

collage
Art made by gluing cut paper, photos, or other materials onto a surface.

scale
The size of something compared with something else.

exquisite corpse
A Surrealist game in which several people draw parts of a figure without seeing the others' parts.

automatism
Drawing or writing without planning, to let the unconscious lead.

REMEMBER

planning and then looks for images in the marks. In the game exquisite corpse, players take turns drawing parts of a figure on a folded paper, so no one sees the whole until the end.

Collage let Surrealists combine pieces of real photographs and prints in impossible ways. Max Ernst cut up old book illustrations to create strange scenes. A quick way to make an image surreal is to change scale: a giant teacup in a city street, or a tiny person standing on a strawberry.

Technique	How it works	Effect
automatism	draw fast with no plan	unexpected shapes
exquisite corpse	draw parts without seeing the others	surprising combinations
collage	cut and combine images	impossible scenes from real pieces
scale change	make something much too big or small	a dreamlike shock

KEY IDEA

Surrealists used automatism, exquisite corpse, collage, and scale change to invite chance and surprise into art.

✓ REMEMBER

Collage, chance games, and scale change bring surprise into Surrealist art.

CREATE · SURREAL COLLAGE

Can real pictures make an impossible scene?

You need: old magazines or printed images; scissors; a glue stick; heavy paper; colored pencils.

Do it on your Studio Sheet: Workbook Lesson 2.2, Part B. The steps and a place to record your results are all there.

3 Check Your Understanding

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Directions: Answer each question. Write your answers in Workbook Lesson 2.2, Part C. Then check with your teacher.

1. What is automatism?
2. How is the exquisite corpse game played?
3. How can changing scale make an image surreal?

WORDS & MORE

REMEMBER

LESSON 2.3
Week 2 · Lesson 1 of 2

Unit 2: Modern Art and Architecture

Lesson 2.3: Abstract Expressionism: Action Painting

TODAY'S GOAL

I can explain how action painters used gesture and process and create an expressive abstract painting.

Standards: NCAS VA:Re7.2, VA:Cr2.1

TODAY'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Do the Warm-Up in Workbook Lesson 2.3, Part A.
- [ ] Read Lesson 2.3 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Create activity, Gesture Painting, on your Studio Sheet (Workbook Lesson 2.3, Part B).
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 2.3, Part C.
- [ ] Finish Workbook Lesson 2.3: Parts D–E.

1 Get Ready

LOOK AND WONDER

Can a painting with no pictures in it show a feeling? Which feeling might a splattered, swirling painting show?

2 Learn

WORDS & MORE

WORDS TO KNOW

abstract
Art that does not show recognizable objects; it uses color, line, shape, and texture on their own.

Abstract Expressionism
An American art movement of the 1940s–1950s that expressed feeling through large, abstract paintings.

gesture
A mark that records the movement of the artist's body.

process
The way an artwork is made.

LOOK AT

Autumn Rhythm (Number 30)
Jackson Pollock, 1950
The Metropolitan Museum of Art · metmuseum.org

REMEMBER

After World War II, New York became a new center of the art world. A group of artists called the Abstract Expressionists made huge abstract paintings that expressed emotions and energy instead of showing objects.

Jackson Pollock laid his canvases on the floor and dripped, poured, and flung paint from sticks and hardened brushes while moving around them. Paintings such as Autumn Rhythm (Number 30) (1950) are webs of looping lines. Critics called this action painting, because each mark is a gesture that records the artist's movement. The process became part of the meaning.

Lee Krasner, Pollock's wife and an important painter in her own right, made bold, rhythmic abstractions. Willem de Kooning used fast, slashing brushstrokes. Although the paintings may look accidental, these artists made many careful choices about color, layers, and when a painting was finished.

WORDS & MORE

WATCH OUT

"My little brother could do that" misses the point. Action painters controlled color, rhythm, layering, and balance across huge canvases, and they chose when to stop.

KEY IDEA

Abstract Expressionists expressed feeling through large abstract paintings. Action painters such as Pollock made the gesture and process part of the art.

✓ REMEMBER

Action painters made gesture and process the subject of abstract art.

CREATE · GESTURE PAINTING

How can movement become a painting?

You need: large paper (or paper taped to the floor outdoors); tempera paint thinned with water in cups; sticks, old brushes, and squeeze bottles; drop cloth or newspaper.

Do it on your Studio Sheet: Workbook Lesson 2.3, Part B. The steps and a place to record your results are all there.

Safety: Work outdoors or on a covered floor; wear old clothes.

REMEMBER

WORDS & MORE

3 Check Your Understanding

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Directions: Answer each question. Write your answers in Workbook Lesson 2.3, Part C. Then check with your teacher.

1. What is abstract art?
2. How did Pollock paint?
3. Why is it called action painting?

REMEMBER

LESSON 2.4
Week 2 · Lesson 2 of 2

Unit 2: Modern Art and Architecture

Lesson 2.4: Color Field Painting

TODAY'S GOAL

I can explain how Color Field painters used large areas of color to create mood and make a color field study.

Standards: NCAS VA:Re7.2, VA:Cr2.1

TODAY'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Do the Warm-Up in Workbook Lesson 2.4, Part A.
- [ ] Read Lesson 2.4 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Create activity, Color Field Study, on your Studio Sheet (Workbook Lesson 2.4, Part B).
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 2.4, Part C.
- [ ] Finish Workbook Lesson 2.4: Parts D–E.

1 Get Ready

LOOK AND WONDER

Stand in front of a wall painted one color. How does it make you feel? Would a different color change your mood?

2 Learn

Some Abstract Expressionists took a quieter path. Color Field painters covered large canvases with broad areas of color to create mood. Instead of energetic gestures, they

WORDS & MORE

WORDS TO KNOW

Color Field
A style of abstract painting that uses large, flat or soft-edged areas of color.

hue
The name of a color, such as red or blue.

saturation
How bright or dull a color is.

soak-stain
A technique of pouring thinned paint onto raw canvas so it soaks in.

LOOK AT

Paintings by Mark Rothko

Mark Rothko, 1950s–1960s
National Gallery of Art · nga.gov, search "Rothko"

Mountains and Sea
Helen Frankenthaler, 1952
National Gallery of Art (on loan) · nga.gov

REMEMBER

wanted viewers to feel surrounded by color.

Mark Rothko painted large canvases with two or three stacked rectangles of color whose soft, blurry edges seem to glow and float. He wanted people to stand close, about 18 inches away, so the color would fill their vision. He said his paintings were about basic human emotions.

Helen Frankenthaler invented the soak-stain technique. In Mountains and Sea (1952), she poured thinned paint onto raw, unprimed canvas on the floor, so the color soaked into the fabric like watercolor. Her method influenced a whole generation of painters.

WORDS & MORE

Choice	Possible effect
warm hues (red, orange)	energy, warmth, excitement
cool hues (blue, green)	calm, distance, sadness
high saturation	intense, bold
low saturation	quiet, muted
soft, blurred edges	glowing, floating
very large size	the viewer feels surrounded

KEY IDEA

Color Field painters used large areas of color, hue, saturation, and soft edges to create mood. Rothko stacked glowing rectangles; Frankenthaler invented soak-stain.

✓ REMEMBER

Color Field painters used large areas of color to create mood.

CREATE · COLOR FIELD STUDY

How do hue, saturation, and edges change mood?

You need: watercolor paper; watercolors or thinned acrylic; a wide brush; a sponge.

Do it on your Studio Sheet: Workbook Lesson 2.4, Part B. The steps and a place to record your results are all there.

3 Check Your Understanding

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Directions: Answer each question. Write your answers in Workbook Lesson 2.4, Part C. Then check with your teacher.

1. What did Rothko want viewers to do?
2. What is soak-stain?
3. What mood might cool, low-saturation colors create?

REMEMBER

LESSON 2.5
Week 3 · Lesson 1 of 2

Unit 2: Modern Art and Architecture

Lesson 2.5: Rhythm and Geometry: Kandinsky and Mondrian

TODAY'S GOAL

I can explain how Kandinsky and Mondrian used line, shape, and color to create rhythm and balance, and make a geometric composition.

Standards: NCAS VA:Re7.2, VA:Cr2.1

TODAY'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Do the Warm-Up in Workbook Lesson 2.5, Part A.
- [ ] Read Lesson 2.5 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Create activity, Rhythm Grid, on your Studio Sheet (Workbook Lesson 2.5, Part B).
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 2.5, Part C.
- [ ] Finish Workbook Lesson 2.5: Parts D–E.

1 Get Ready

LOOK AND WONDER

Can a painting have a beat like music? What would a fast song look like as shapes and colors?

2 Learn

WORDS & MORE

WORDS TO KNOW

rhythm
A sense of movement made by repeating lines, shapes, or colors.

asymmetrical balance
Balance made with different things on each side that have equal visual weight.

primary colors
Red, yellow, and blue.

geometric abstraction
Abstract art built from geometric shapes such as squares, lines, and circles.

REMEMBER

Wassily Kandinsky was one of the first artists to paint purely abstract pictures, around 1910–1913. He loved music and believed colors and shapes could affect people the way sounds do. He even named works Compositions and Improvisations, like pieces of music.

Piet Mondrian, a Dutch painter, simplified art down to the basics: straight black lines, white space, and blocks of the primary colors. In Composition with Red, Blue and Yellow (1930), a large red square is balanced by small blue and yellow rectangles. This is asymmetrical balance: the sides differ but feel equal.

Late in life, Mondrian moved to New York and fell in love with jazz and the city's grid of streets. In Broadway Boogie Woogie (1942–1943), he replaced black lines with yellow lines broken into tiny squares of red, blue, and gray, like blinking traffic and lively rhythm.

WORDS & MORE

LOOK AT

Composition with Red, Blue and Yellow
Piet Mondrian, 1930
Kunsthaus Zürich (search the title for a photo)

Broadway Boogie Woogie
Piet Mondrian, 1942–43
Museum of Modern Art, New York · moma.org

KEY IDEA

Kandinsky linked abstract art to music. Mondrian used black lines, white space, and primary colors to create asymmetrical balance and, later, the rhythm of jazz and the city.

CREATE · RHYTHM GRID

Can lines and colors create a visual beat?

You need: white paper; a ruler; black marker or tape; red, yellow, and blue markers or paint; a song with a strong beat.

Do it on your Studio Sheet: Workbook Lesson 2.5, Part B. The steps and a place to record your results are all there.

3 Check Your Understanding

✓ REMEMBER

Kandinsky linked art and music; Mondrian balanced lines and primary colors.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Directions: Answer each question. Write your answers in Workbook Lesson 2.5, Part C. Then check with your teacher.

1. Why did Kandinsky name his paintings like music?
2. Which colors did Mondrian use?
3. What is asymmetrical balance?

REMEMBER

LESSON 2.6
Week 3 · Lesson 2 of 2

Unit 2: Modern Art and Architecture

Lesson 2.6: Abstraction from Nature: O'Keeffe and Alma Thomas

TODAY'S GOAL

I can explain how artists abstracted nature through close-ups, simplification, and pattern, and create an abstraction from a natural object.

Standards: NCAS VA:Re7.1, VA:Cr1.2

TODAY'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Do the Warm-Up in Workbook Lesson 2.6, Part A.
- [ ] Read Lesson 2.6 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Create activity, From Nature to Abstraction, on your Studio Sheet (Workbook Lesson 2.6, Part B).
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 2.6, Part C.
- [ ] Finish Workbook Lesson 2.6: Parts D–E.

1 Get Ready

LOOK AND WONDER

Look at a leaf through a magnifying glass. Does it still look like a leaf, or more like a map or a pattern?

WORDS & MORE

WORDS TO KNOW

abstraction
Simplifying or changing something real so its shapes, colors, or patterns stand out.

close-up
A view from very near, so a small thing fills the whole picture.

simplify
To leave out details and keep the most important shapes.

mosaic-like
Made of many small pieces placed side by side, like tiles.

REMEMBER

2 Learn

Not all abstract art starts from nothing. Many artists begin with something real and simplify it until shapes, colors, and patterns become the subject.

Georgia O'Keeffe painted flowers as enormous close-ups, filling a whole canvas with a single blossom. In works such as Jimson Weed (1936), petals curve and swirl into smooth shapes. She said she painted flowers big so busy people would take time to look at them. Later, in New Mexico, she simplified hills, bones, and sky into bold shapes.

Alma Thomas taught art in Washington, D.C., for 35 years, then became a celebrated painter in her 70s. Inspired by the flowers and trees in her garden and by views from space, she painted rows of short, bright brushstrokes that look like mosaics or sunlight through leaves, as in Resurrection (1966). In 1972, she became the first Black woman to have a solo exhibition at New York's Whitney Museum of American Art.

Strategy	O'Keeffe	Alma Thomas
starting point	a flower, a bone, a hill	garden flowers, trees, space
method	extreme close-up and smooth simplified shapes	rows of short, bright strokes
effect	a familiar thing looks new and monumental	shimmering color and rhythm

KEY IDEA

Artists can abstract nature by zooming in, simplifying shapes, and turning color into pattern. O'Keeffe used close-ups; Alma Thomas used rows of bright strokes.

✓ REMEMBER

Artists abstract nature through close-ups, simplification, and pattern.

CREATE · FROM NATURE TO ABSTRACTION

How can you turn a natural object into an abstract artwork?

You need: a leaf, flower, shell, or slice of fruit; a viewfinder (a small square cut in paper); drawing paper; colored pencils, markers, or paint.

Do it on your Studio Sheet: Workbook Lesson 2.6, Part B. The steps and a place to record your results are all there.

WORDS & MORE

LOOK AT

Flower paintings
Georgia O'Keeffe, 1920s–1930s
Georgia O'Keeffe Museum · okeeffemuseum.org

Resurrection
Alma Thomas, 1966
The White House collection (search the title for a photo)

REMEMBER

WORDS & MORE

3 Check Your Understanding

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Directions: Answer each question. Write your answers in Workbook Lesson 2.6, Part C. Then check with your teacher.

1. Why did O'Keeffe paint flowers so large?
2. What did Alma Thomas's paintings look like?
3. What does it mean to simplify in art?

REMEMBER

LESSON 2.7
Week 4 · Lesson 1 of 2

Unit 2: Modern Art and Architecture

Lesson 2.7: Twentieth-Century Architecture: Form Follows Function

TODAY'S GOAL

I can explain key ideas of modern architecture and design a building that fits its site and purpose.

Standards: NCAS VA:Re7.1, VA:Cn11

TODAY'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Do the Warm-Up in Workbook Lesson 2.7, Part A.
- [ ] Read Lesson 2.7 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Create activity, Design for a Site, on your Studio Sheet (Workbook Lesson 2.7, Part B).
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 2.7, Part C.
- [ ] Finish Workbook Lesson 2.7: Parts D–E.

1 Get Ready

LOOK AND WONDER

If you could design a house for your favorite place in nature, what would it look like, and why?

2 Learn

WORDS & MORE

WORDS TO KNOW

form follows function
The idea that a building's shape should come from its purpose.

organic architecture
Frank Lloyd Wright's idea that buildings should fit in harmony with their natural site.

cantilever
A beam or floor that sticks out, supported at only one end.

Bauhaus
A German art and design school (1919–1933) that joined art, craft, and industry.

REMEMBER

In 1896, the American architect Louis Sullivan wrote that form follows function: a building's shape should come from what it's used for. Modern architects of the 1900s threw out heavy decoration and borrowed columns, and designed with steel, concrete, and glass.

Frank Lloyd Wright believed in organic architecture, buildings in harmony with their sites. His most famous house, Fallingwater (1935–1939) in Pennsylvania, sits right over a waterfall. Its concrete terraces are cantilevers that stretch out over the stream, echoing the rock ledges below. Wright also designed the spiraling Guggenheim Museum in New York (1959). Mississippi has a Wright house too: Fountainhead (1954) in Jackson.

In Germany, the Bauhaus school, founded by Walter Gropius in 1919, taught that good design should be simple, useful, and made for everyone. Its ideas led to the International Style: flat roofs, white walls, ribbon windows, and open floor plans.

Idea	What it looks like
form follows function	shapes that come from a building's use; little decoration
organic architecture	natural materials and shapes that fit the land
cantilever	floors or roofs that reach out with no posts beneath
International Style	flat roofs, glass walls, open interiors

KEY IDEA

Modern architects designed from function and new materials. Wright's organic architecture fit buildings to their sites; the Bauhaus taught simple, useful design for everyone.

✓ REMEMBER

Modern architecture grew from function, new materials, and harmony with the site.

CREATE · DESIGN FOR A SITE

How can a building fit its place and purpose?

You need: drawing paper and graph paper; pencil and ruler; colored pencils.

Do it on your Studio Sheet: Workbook Lesson 2.7, Part B. The steps and a place to record your results are all there.

WORDS & MORE

LOOK AT

Fallingwater
Frank Lloyd Wright, 1935–39
Mill Run, Pennsylvania · fallingwater.org

Fountainhead
Frank Lloyd Wright, 1954
Jackson, Mississippi (a private home; search for photos)

REMEMBER

WORDS & MORE

3 Check Your Understanding

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Directions: Answer each question. Write your answers in Workbook Lesson 2.7, Part C. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does form follows function mean?
2. What is a cantilever?
3. Name a Frank Lloyd Wright building in Mississippi.

REMEMBER

LESSON 2.8
Week 4 · Lesson 2 of 2

Unit 2: Modern Art and Architecture

Lesson 2.8: Modern Art Portfolio and Artist Statement

TODAY'S GOAL

I can select, revise, and present work from this unit with an artist statement that connects my art to modern movements.

Standards: NCAS VA:Pr4, VA:Pr5, VA:Re9

TODAY'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Do the Warm-Up in Workbook Lesson 2.8, Part A.
- [ ] Read Lesson 2.8 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Create activity, Portfolio Show, on your Studio Sheet (Workbook Lesson 2.8, Part B).
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 2.8, Part C.
- [ ] Finish Workbook Lesson 2.8: Part D.

1 Get Ready

LOOK AND WONDER

If a gallery offered to show three pieces of your art, which would you choose, and what would you want visitors to know?

2 Learn

WORDS & MORE

WORDS TO KNOW

portfolio
A collection of an artist's best work.

artist statement
A short text in which an artist explains their ideas, process, and influences.

influence
An artist or idea that affects your own work.

curate
To choose and arrange artworks for a show.

REMEMBER

Artists don't show everything they make. They curate a portfolio of their strongest and most meaningful work and write an artist statement so viewers understand their ideas. In this lesson, you'll curate work from Units 1 and 2 and connect it to the modern movements you studied.

An artist statement answers...	Example sentence
What did you make?	This series explores dreams and memory through collage and gesture.
How did you make it?	I combined magazine images, changed their scale, and added drawn shadows.
Who influenced you?	Like Magritte, I juxtaposed objects to make viewers question what they see.
What do you want viewers to feel or think?	I hope viewers look twice and wonder what is real.

STEP BY STEP · REVISE BEFORE YOU PRESENT

A gesture painting feels muddy in the center.

1 Critique: the colors mixed too much where layers overlapped.

2 Plan: add one clean, bright gesture across the center.

3 Decide: step back and stop when the balance feels right.

Look for: Revising one piece can make a portfolio much stronger.

KEY IDEA

Artists curate portfolios and write artist statements that explain their ideas, process, and influences.

CREATE · PORTFOLIO SHOW

How can you present your work like a professional artist?

You need: your Unit 1 and Unit 2 artwork; index cards; a wall, table, or digital slides.

Do it on your Studio Sheet: Workbook Lesson 2.8, Part B. The steps and a place to record your results are all there.

✓ REMEMBER

Curate your best work and explain it in an artist statement.

WORDS & MORE

REMEMBER

WORDS & MORE

3 Check Your Understanding

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Directions: Answer each question. Write your answers in Workbook Lesson 2.8, Part C. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does it mean to curate a portfolio?
2. Name three questions an artist statement answers.
3. Why revise a piece before presenting it?

UNIT 2 REVIEW

Unit 2 Study Guide

Use this page to get ready for the unit test. Read each big idea, then try the review pages in your workbook.

Lesson	Remember…
2.1	Surrealists painted dreamlike, impossible scenes with realistic technique.
2.2	Collage, chance games, and scale change bring surprise into Surrealist art.
2.3	Action painters made gesture and process the subject of abstract art.
2.4	Color Field painters used large areas of color to create mood.
2.5	Kandinsky linked art and music; Mondrian balanced lines and primary colors.
2.6	Artists abstract nature through close-ups, simplification, and pattern.
2.7	Modern architecture grew from function, new materials, and harmony with the site.
2.8	Curate your best work and explain it in an artist statement.

Glossary

abstract	Art without recognizable objects.
Abstract Expressionism	An American art movement of the 1940s–1950s that expressed feeling through large, abstract paintings.
abstraction	Simplifying or changing something real so its shapes, colors, or patterns stand out.
analogous	Neighboring colors.
artist statement	Explanation of an artwork.
asymmetrical balance	Different elements arranged so visual weight feels even.
automatism	Drawing or writing without planning, to let the unconscious lead.
Bauhaus	A German art and design school (1919–1933) that joined art, craft, and industry.
canon of proportion	A set of rules for ideal body proportions.
cantilever	A beam or floor that sticks out, supported at only one end.
cast shadow	The shadow an object throws onto another surface.
chiaroscuro	Strong light-dark contrast.
close-up	A view from very near, so a small thing fills the whole picture.
collage	Art made by gluing cut paper, photos, or other materials onto a surface.
Color Field	Large areas of color creating mood.
complementary	Colors opposite on the wheel.
contour drawing	A drawing of an object's edges, made with careful, continuous line.
core shadow	The darkest part on the form, turned away from the light.
critique	Structured discussion of art.
curate	To choose and arrange artworks for a show.
elements of art	Line, shape, form, color, value, texture, and space.
exquisite corpse	A Surrealist game in which several people draw parts of a figure without seeing the others' parts.
foreshortening	Drawing an object that points toward the viewer so it looks shorter.
form follows function	A building's shape comes from its purpose.
geometric abstraction	Abstract art built from geometric shapes such as squares, lines, and circles.
gesture	A mark that records movement.

gesture drawing	A quick drawing that captures movement and pose.
hatching	Parallel lines for value.
highlight	The brightest spot, where light hits most directly.
hue	The name of a color on the wheel (red, blue-green).
illusionism	Painting so realistically that something seems real.
influence	An artist or idea that affects your own work.
interpret	To explain what an artwork means or expresses.
juxtaposition	Placing very different things side by side to surprise the viewer.
leading lines	Lines that guide the eye toward the focal point.
light source	The direction light comes from.
mosaic-like	Made of many small pieces placed side by side, like tiles.
negative space	The empty space around and between objects.
organic architecture	Frank Lloyd Wright's idea that buildings should fit in harmony with their natural site.
peer critique	Structured feedback from classmates or family.
portfolio	A collection of an artist's best work.
primary colors	Red, yellow, and blue.
principles of design	How artists arrange the elements: balance, contrast, emphasis, movement, pattern, rhythm, unity, and proportion.
process	The way an artwork is made.
proportion	Size relationships between parts and the whole.
reflected light	Dim light bounced back onto the shadow side from nearby surfaces.
rhythm	A sense of movement made by repeating lines, shapes, or colors.
rule of thirds	Placing key elements on thirds.
saturation	How intense or dull a color is (also called intensity).
scale	The size of something compared with something else.
simplify	To leave out details and keep the most important shapes.
soak-stain	A technique of pouring thinned paint onto raw canvas so it soaks in.
stippling	Dots that create value; closer dots look darker.
Surrealism	Art of dreams and the unconscious.
tenebrism	Extreme chiaroscuro, with figures emerging from deep darkness.

triadic	Three colors evenly spaced around the wheel.
unconscious	The part of the mind that holds thoughts and feelings we aren't aware of.
value scale	A sequence of even steps from white to black.

Grade 7 Art

Student Textbook

A full year of Grade 7 arts: drawing, painting, and design; music; art history; theater and dance; media arts; and sculpture. Every lesson pairs looking closely at real artwork with hands-on studio time, and the year ends with a portfolio and a show.

This Student Textbook teaches every lesson: the big idea, key vocabulary, models and examples, and a short set of practice problems to check understanding. It pairs with the Student Workbook and the Teacher Edition.

INSIDE THIS YEAR

01 The Elements of Art

02 Modern Art and Architecture

IN THIS BOOK

- Clear lesson goals: “I can…” statements
- Key vocabulary with student-friendly definitions
- Models, examples, and Key Idea summaries
- A study guide and glossary for every unit

THE COMPLETE SET



Textbook
You are holding this book

Workbook

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Each lesson has the same number in all three books, so the textbook, workbook, and teacher pages always match.